

The 5-Step Platform Validation Method

See the market first. Then map your real experience against it.

Before you build a learning platform, validate it. Most people do it backwards: they pick an idea in the dark, build for months, and find out the market already answered the question. Do these five steps in order. It takes about 60 to 90 minutes total.

Step 1: Competitor Analysis

PASTE INTO CLAUDE

"I am considering building a subscription learning platform in [YOUR AREA]. Help me identify 8 to 10 existing platforms, courses, or communities already serving this audience. Include what they charge, their format, and their core promise."

Heads up: before you write anything down, visit each competitor and confirm it exists and the price is current. AI works from memory, so some will be stale. Twenty minutes of clicking turns a guess into real data. For each competitor, note: Name, Price, Format, Core Promise.

Step 2: Listen Where They Hang Out

PASTE INTO CLAUDE

"Where does [YOUR AUDIENCE] hang out online to talk about [TOPIC]? List the specific subreddits, Facebook groups, Skool communities, Discord servers, forums, and YouTube channels where they ask questions and vent frustrations."

Then go to 3 or 4 of those places and read the real threads. Look for: questions asked over and over, phrases like "I wish there was" or "does anyone know how to," what they complain about in the tools they already use, and what they already pay for. Write down the exact phrases they use. That becomes your marketing language later.

Step 3: Find the Gap

PASTE INTO CLAUDE (with your Step 1 list and Step 2 quotes)

"Based on this competitor list and these real complaints I gathered: [paste quotes], what is underserved or missing in this market, and what do customers complain about most?"

A gap people are already paying money to complain about is a validated gap. "Nothing exists for X" often just means nobody wants X.

Step 4: The Real Check. Do You Actually Have This?

No AI for this one. Be honest. Which gap matches something you have done repeatedly, enough times that you have seen it go wrong in different ways and know how to handle it? Can you name 3 or more real situations where you did this, not just one story? If yes, that is your real angle, go to Step 5. If no, that gap is not yours to claim yet. Do not quit. Go get the reps: teach it free to 5 people this month. That is your 3 situations, and your first testimonials.

Step 5: Positioning Statement

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"Given this gap and my real experience in [X], write my positioning statement using this formula: I help [specific who] achieve [specific measurable outcome] in [timeframe], even without [common obstacle]. Make the who and the outcome as specific as possible, and give me 3 versions, each more specific than the last."

Example: "I help busy nurses pass the NCLEX in 60 days without expensive prep courses." Test it: would a stranger instantly know who it is for and why you? If not, run it again with more of your specifics.

Your Checklist

- ☐ Step 1: 8 to 10 competitors listed and verified
- ☐ Step 2: Read real threads and wrote down their exact phrases
- ☐ Step 3: Named the validated gap
- ☐ Step 4: Confirmed 3 or more real situations (or started getting the reps)
- ☐ Step 5: Wrote my positioning statement

Ready to actually build it?

This is exactly what we do, step by step, inside the Leveraging AI community. Come build your platform with me.

Join here: skool.com/leveragingai